

ADL v0.91.8 — External Review Findings

Chat lane · independent technical review

Date	2026-08-04
Packet	THIRD_PARTY_REVIEW_HANDOFF_v0.91.8.md
Review outcome	blocked
Findings	1 P1, 2 P2, plus residual risks
Target revision	none — packet not frozen (see F1)

Method and honesty boundary

Verified directly this pass: the handoff send gate and Target Revision table; workspace and adl/src directory sizes and file counts, compared against an identically-measured v0.91.7 baseline; DELETION_AND_CUTOVER_v0.91.8.md.

Not done, therefore not asserted: no build, no test execution, no cargo audit, no git operations (so no digest computation, no SHA verification, and no confirmation of which revision this working tree corresponds to), no GitHub issue or PR state refresh, no AWS operations.

No per-category score is assigned. A numeric scorecard across categories that were not exercised (test execution, runtime behaviour, broad security, performance) would not be evidence-backed. Scores appear in this review only where something was actually measured.

Because the packet has no frozen target revision, none of these findings can be bound to a commit SHA. They describe the working tree as read on 2026-08-04 and must be re-verified against the eventual frozen revision.

Findings

F1 · V0918-CHAT-01 — P1

summary	The send gate is unsatisfied: the Target Revision table has no pull request, head branch, exact commit SHA, or packet digest, so there is no frozen revision to review.
evidence	THIRD_PARTY_REVIEW_HANDOFF_v0.91.8.md, Target Revision table: <i>Pull request</i> , <i>Head branch</i> , <i>Exact commit SHA</i> , and <i>Review packet digest</i> all read “TBD before send”. Metadata: <i>Packet status: ready_to_freeze_not_sent</i> , <i>Review performed: false</i> . Live truth section lists WP-19 #5357 (formal external-review owner) and #5804 (prerequisite repair) as open.
impact	No review of this packet can be bound to a revision, which defeats the stale-revision rule and the digest procedure. Any findings returned now are unanchored and become stale on the next commit. v0.91.8 cannot be closed on this packet.
invariant	Handoff Send Gate: fill Repository, PR, base, head, and exact commit SHA; if any gate fails, return blocked.
failure_mode	A milestone could be treated as externally reviewed on the basis of a review performed against an unpinned working tree, with the packet's own integrity mechanism (digest plus frozen SHA) bypassed rather than failed.
remediation	Freeze the packet: populate PR, head branch, exact SHA, and computed digest per the Digest Procedure; resolve #5804; dispatch WP-19 #5357; then re-run review against the frozen revision.
residual_risk	None once the gate is satisfied. The gate is correctly designed and simply has not been run.

F2 · V0918-CHAT-02 — P2

summary	The post-deletion validation metric is self-validating: deleted lines and the pinned denominator are the same number, so the measurement cannot fail regardless of how much deletable code remains.
evidence	docs/milestones/v0.91.8/features/DELETION_AND_CUTOVER_v0.91.8.md: records status <i>pass</i> and 46,358 deleted lines against the 46,358-line pinned denominator. Underlying artifact cited as evidence/wp13/5346-post-deletion-validation.v1.json (not independently read this pass).
impact	The metric reports 100% completion of deletion by construction. It provides no information about remaining legacy surface and cannot detect under-deletion, so cutover progress is not measurable from this evidence.
invariant	Planned-versus-proven separation: a proof artifact must be capable of returning a failing result.
failure_mode	Same class as a status field asserting success for a check that did not compare anything (cf. v0.91.7 account_profile_validation_status “sts_verified”). A reviewer or v0.92 consumer reads status <i>pass</i> and infers cutover is complete while residual legacy surface is unquantified.

remediation	Derive the denominator independently of the deletion event — total lines in legacy surfaces declared deletion-eligible by the eligibility manifest, computed before deletion — and publish the delta (eligible minus deleted) as the cutover-progress figure.
residual_risk	If the eligibility manifest is itself scoped to what was already deleted, the circularity moves up one level rather than being removed. Review the manifest's scope alongside the fix.

F3 · V0918-CHAT-03 — P2

summary	The milestone's code-reduction claim is not supported at workspace level: the legacy crate grew, and additional crates were added, so total tracked source is up rather than down.
evidence	adl/src measured 2026-08-04: 3.26 MB, 97 files, 21 subdirectories . Same path measured identically at v0.91.7: 3.18 MB, 96 files . Largest files unchanged and still present: long_lived_agent.rs (209 KB), csm_runtime_api.rs (198 KB), aws_remote_validation.rs (194 KB), resilience.rs (192 KB), scheduler.rs (162 KB). Workspace additionally contains adl-v2/crates/ (10 crates), adl-characterization/, adl-resilience/, alongside adl-runtime/, adl-runtime-kernel/, csdlc-v2/, adl-spec/.
impact	The dual-implementation state flagged at v0.91.7 has widened, not closed. Two sources of truth for runtime and control-plane behaviour mean a fix landing in one and not the other is invisible until it manifests. This is the highest ongoing maintenance risk in the workspace.
invariant	Acceptance-before-deletion and cutover-proof requirements (handoff risk theme 6): deletion must actually reduce the surface it claims to retire.
failure_mode	v0.92 is described as booting the fully integrated runtime, while subsystems it depends on (affect, reasoning/skill, curiosity) still have implementations in the legacy crate. A full-integration claim could be made while the executing code paths remain the legacy ones.
remediation	Publish a per-subsystem cutover table stating, for each subsystem v0.92 claims (chronosense, AEE, affect, reasoning graph, skills, curiosity), which crate's implementation executes on the boot path. Then land the legacy deletion PR with evidence that nothing calls the retired paths.
residual_risk	Deletion is only safe once parity is proven. If parity proof is weaker than assumed, deletion converts a maintenance risk into a functional regression. Sequence parity proof before deletion, not after.

Residual risks (informational)

Review independence

Every review lane in this milestone — internal (WP-18), per-issue shadows, and this chat lane — is dispatched, prompted, and consumed by the system under review. Corpus-integrity mechanisms (digest, frozen revision, dispatch receipt) are well designed and address tampering, but they do not establish reviewer independence. No review in the v0.91.8 packet is performed by a party the operator does not control.

New-crate size regrowth

csdlc-v2/store.rs was already 129 KB at v0.91.7. The module-size pattern that produced the legacy crate's 200 KB files is visible in the replacement tree. Adopt a module-size limit now, while the new crates are young.

Doc-to-code drift precedent

At v0.91.7 the primary reasoning-graph feature doc stated “runtime implementation: out of scope” while roughly 90 KB of reasoning implementation was landed. The gate that should have caught a feature doc contradicting landed code did not fire. Worth a root-cause pass before v0.92 relies on feature docs as consumption evidence.

What was verified as sound

The handoff itself is well constructed and should not be weakened by the findings above. Its send gate, stale-revision rule, digest procedure, reviewer-authority limits, explicit non-claims, and blocked/deferred/findings_returned/no_findings outcome vocabulary are the reason this review could reach a defensible *blocked* result rather than an inferred one. The packet correctly refuses to let a reviewer infer release readiness from incomplete truth — and that is exactly what it did here.

Recommended close path

1. Resolve #5804; freeze the packet with a real SHA and computed digest (F1).
2. Derive an independent deletion denominator and republish cutover progress (F2).
3. Publish the per-subsystem boot-path cutover table (F3).
4. Dispatch WP-19 #5357 against the frozen revision.